

Introduction

What you're reading is printed on paper, but was originally written on a computer inside a word processor. So what's real? The paper in your hands or the original document in which it was created? Absurd question, yes but then there are questions which when pondered over can bend the perceptions of reality. Leaving philosophies where they belong, the point we're trying to make here is that virtualization is a similar concept and definitely something you want to try your hands at, if you've not already. Once you get a hang of it, you'll keep returning to it. How can we be so sure, you ask?

None of us is completely satisfied with our computers. There's always something lacking for the enthusiasts. A Windows user might just want an awesome environment that Linux offers with all the free and powerful goodies, a Linux user might miss the might of Microsoft Word and a Mac user might want a break away from fancy GUI by trying out something else. No matter what your needs – be it software development, configuration testing, office document creation, software use on only one particular OS or just testing what's new in an overhyped OS (read Windows 8) – virtualization is for you. It allows you to install new operating system(s) on the same machine without worrying about hard disk formats or the risk of destroying things.

Virtualization is a world in itself and powers many of the new and upcoming technologies. Right from allowing you to scan for safety against viruses to cloud computing, it's expanding everywhere. New tools are being made and careers are being born. Virtualization is a silent revolution and you can be a part of it. What you're holding in your hand is a 5 X 7.5-inched window to an exciting world which may just rock your perception of what a desktop is! 